

In This Month's

EFY^{CD}

Focus on Open Source Compilers

TOP 5 SOFTWARE



Watcom C/C++. The Watcom C/C++ compiler is popular for high execution speed of the compiled code that it produces. Though no longer sold commercially by Sybase, it has been made available as the open source. The compiler code is portable and, like many other open source compiler projects such as GCC, the compiler backend (code generator) is retargetable. The compiler can be operated from, and generate executable code for, the DOS, OS/2 and Windows operating systems.

Watcom FORTRAN/77. It is a Fortran 77 compiler by the Open Watcom—a project of the open source community to maintain and enhance Watcom C, C++, and Fortran cross-compilers and tools. Some Open Watcom tools currently do not function properly if installed in a directory with spaces in the name. For proper operation, Open Watcom compilers require a few environment variables to be set up correctly. Read the Read Me file if your installation does not work.

FreeBASIC. FreeBASIC is a free/open source (GPL), 32-bit BASIC compiler for Microsoft Windows, protected-mode DOS (DOS extender), Linux and Xbox. It allows a high level of support for programs written for

QBasic, by using the 'QB' dialect. Many programs written for QBasic will compile and run in this mode without requiring any change.

Free Pascal. Free Pascal (FPC for short) is a free, portable and open source compiler for Pascal and Object Pascal. It is a 32-/64-bit multi-architecture and multi-operating system compiler that implements the Borland Pascal dialects—Turbo Pascal and Delphi—as well as some Mac Pascal constructs, and is available for most common operating systems.

VUTRAX. Key features of VUTRAX electronics schematic and PCB design package include integrated schematic capture, tutorial integrated with the system, design for modern PCB technology, and capabilities for RF and microwave design. VUTRAX is capable of running on Windows 95, Windows 98, Windows ME, Windows NT 3.51, Windows NT 4.0, Windows 2000, Windows XP, Windows Vista and Windows 7. Linux version is also available.

IAR visualSTATE. IAR visualSTATE is a UML-compliant graphical state machine design tool for embedded systems. It provides advanced verification and validation tools and generates very compact 'C' code that is consistent with your system design.

